

DESIGN STATEMENT



Town and Country Planning Act 1990

Proposed construction of a new detached single storey 3-bedroom 'self and custom build' dwelling and construction of a detached single storey car port with access driveway and vehicular parking on land to rear of 124 Cheltenham Road, Bishops Cleeve, GL52 8LZ.

2505/ Design Statement

Document control

VERSION	DATE	REVISION	AUTHOR
1	06/10/2025		DS

Approved for release;

Boughton Butler Ltd.

www.boughtonbutler.co.uk[@BoughtonButler](https://twitter.com/BoughtonButler)

Contents

1. Introduction	Page 4
2. Existing Site	Page 5
3. Site Photos	Page 6
4. Planning History and Fall Back	Page 9
5. Design Proposals	Page 11
6. Conclusion	Page 15

1. Introduction

Location

The site is located off Cheltenham Road, Bishops Cleeve on residential curtilage at the rear of the host dwelling 124 Cheltenham Road.

Proposal

The proposal is for the construction of a detached single storey self-build/custom build dwelling with pedestrian and vehicular access onto the Cheltenham Road, on-site vehicle parking and car port, and private garden. The proposal would divide the existing residential curtilage of 124 Cheltenham Road with new boundary fencing. The existing parking and access arrangements for the host dwelling will remain unchanged as part of the proposals.

The application site is currently owned by the parents of the applicant, Mr J Edwards, of whom seeks to construct a self/custom build house for his family. The multi-generational approach to the site and the design conception has involved all members of the family in coming to a mutually acceptable and beneficial design approach to the site; including the severance of the gardens, landscaping and specific design of the dwelling itself.

The site is adjacent to the recently approved single-storey dwelling on land at the rear of 118 Cheltenham Road, which sets an in principle and design precedence for development to the rear of the large properties fronting Cheltenham Road in this particular part of Bishop's Cleeve.

The application site is subject to two refused planning applications (21/01491/FUL and 22/00656/FUL) of which are not considered to have any bearing on the determination of this self-build application due to the substantial differences and quality of the design, as well as the recent adjacent approval and the Council's housing land supply¹

¹ Being 3.65 years, and as such Paragraph 11D of the Framework sets out there is a presumption in favour of sustainable development.

2. Existing Site

The site is approximately 0.08 Hectares in size and is accessed via an existing vehicular driveway off Cheltenham Road, Bishops Cleeve. The site contains the property no.124 of which is a large detached early 20th century property with garaging and substantial front and rear gardens, including the application site. The wider curtilage of the host dwelling also

projects north to the rear of properties 120 and 122 Cheltenham Road in a 'dog legged' fashion, meeting the boundary of 118 Cheltenham Road.

The site is enclosed on the north, south, east and west boundaries by tall non-native hedgerows and various trees. The site also contains a variety of domestic outbuildings such as greenhouses, sheds and summer houses however, does not contain any substantial permanent structures.

In terms of topography the site is relatively flat and does not present any significant changes of level or embankments. The site, from its access onto the Highway falls from +54.5m AOD to 52.60m AOD at its lowest point, and given the depth of the site this represents a gradient of a 1:40 fall from east to west, from the Cheltenham Road.

There are residential dwellings on all sides of the site, as well as the recently approved dwelling at 118 Cheltenham Road immediately north of the site (23/00807/FUL). To the east the site (once divided) will be bound by the retained residential curtilage of 124 Cheltenham Road, and to the south the gardens of 126 Cheltenham Road. To the west the site is bound by the more recent 'The Nurseries' housing development with gardens abutting the boundary of the application site.

There are no dwellings within close proximity to the site that would give rise to any overlooking into the site from first floor windows due to the distances from the application site.

3. Site Photos



Existing front elevation of the host dwelling 124 Cheltenham Road, from Cheltenham Road



A view of the site from the east, showing the existing boundaries and natural features.



The site (centre) showing the host dwelling and properties fronting Cheltenham Road, and the adjacent development to the West of the site.



Image showing the site towards the western boundary.



The site looking south west showing the southern boundary

4. Planning History and Precedence

The planning history associated with the application site is relatively recent, with two refused applications for a new dwelling. The applications are:

21/01491/FUL - Erection of a dwelling including associated parking and amenity space.

Refusal reason(s):

1. The proposal, by virtue of the site parameters, its siting and design, would fail to respect the character of the area and would be contrary to the spatial pattern within the area. The contrived and cramped layout would fail to respect the development within the wider area and not constitute good design. The proposal would therefore have a harmful impact on the character and appearance of the area. The proposal is therefore contrary to Policy SD4 of the Gloucester, Cheltenham and Tewkesbury Joint Core Strategy 2011-2031 (2017), emerging Policy RES5 of the Pre-submission Tewkesbury Borough Plan (October 2019) and the National Planning Policy Framework.

2. By way of layout, the proposal results in an unacceptable level of natural light into and outlook from internal spaces detrimental to the enjoyment of the future occupant of the proposed dwelling contrary to Policies SD4 and SD14 of the Gloucester, Cheltenham and Tewkesbury Joint Core Strategy 2011-2031 and Emerging Policy RES5 of the Pre-Submission Tewkesbury Local Plan, October 2019

22/00656/FUL - Proposed erection of dwelling including parking and amenity space.

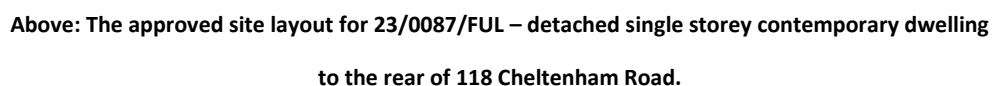
Refusal reason(s):

1. The proposal, by virtue of the site parameters, its incongruous siting and design, would fail to respect the character of the area and would be contrary to the spatial pattern within the area. The contrived and cramped layout would fail to respect the development within the wider area and not constitute good design. The proposal would therefore have a harmful impact on the character and appearance of the area. The proposal is therefore contrary to Policy SD4 of the Gloucester, Cheltenham and Tewkesbury Joint Core Strategy 2011-2031 (2017), Policy RES5 of the Tewkesbury Borough Plan (June 2022) and the National Planning Policy Framework.

It is considered that the previous applications bear no material similarity to the current (new) application for the self-build dwelling. In the first instance the design approach for the current application is holistically different, both in terms of siting and location of the new dwelling but also its architectural form and appearance. As such, whilst the site has planning history this has no bearing on any future decision making, where previous submissions are considered architecturally poor and do not represent good design.

118 Cheltenham Road (ref 23/0087/FUL)

The design of the new self-build dwelling has also taken architectural cues from the approved dwelling at no.118, in terms of its form and external appearance and low-impact design.

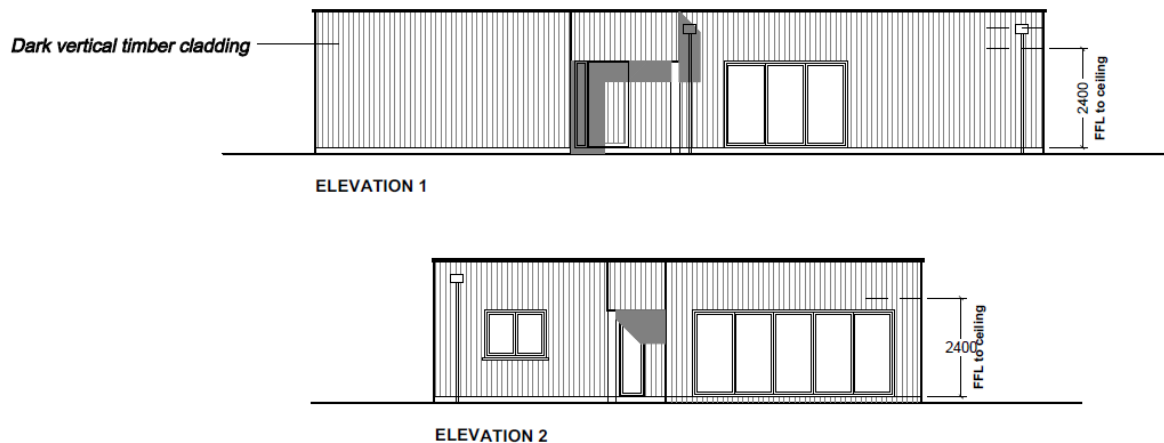


5. Design Proposals

Design

A series of design intentions, specific to the site have led to the final scheme applied for. These are considered to be sensitive to the location (the built and natural environment), but also encompass the applicant's specific needs in a high quality and contemporary manner. It is considered the proposals significantly improve the local and wider built context, leading to an enhancement to the site.

Furthermore the proposed new self-build and custom-build dwelling will make the best use of land within a built up location, avoiding the need for the applicant to look wider within rural locations.



Above: An principal elevations of the new dwellings.

Siting and Location

The location of the proposed new dwelling to be located in the most western parcel of the site, with the dwelling sitting neatly between the neighbouring boundaries of 126 Cheltenham Road and No.31 'The Nurseries'. The plan form is 'L' shaped so that it responds to the unique dog-legged shape of the site and its natural constraints (trees and boundaries).

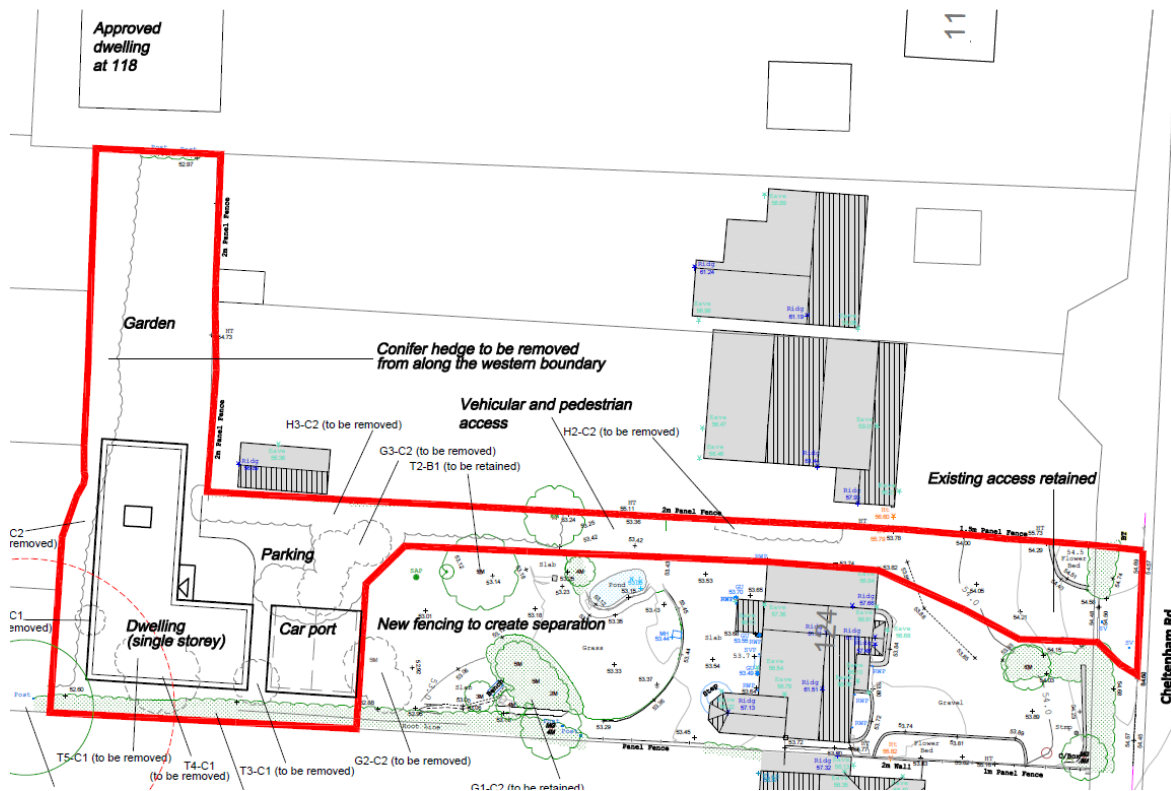
The western part of the application site is also relatively level, with levels not materially differing on both north to south, and east to west orientations and as such the new dwelling will not require any major earthworks or manipulation of levels to facilitate its single-storey stature.

The proposed dwelling seeks to provide a 'buffer' from the existing boundaries to allow for both natural light to the bedroom spaces to the south, east and west, and allow a formal

aspect northwards to the garden area. This makes best use of the site whilst respecting the adjacent garden areas.

Some ornamental shrub and tree planting will be removed in order to facilitate the new access road and dwelling, of which will provide more openness internally to the site. New boundary treatments can be proposed where necessary, including new landscaping to provide further enhancement to the site and its neighbours.

The new dwelling is proposed to sit as feasibly west into the site, and seeks to contextualise with the established building line of the newly approved dwelling at 118 Cheltenham Road which is immediately north of the site, therefore be seen in this context and both 'plots' would homogenise as one.



Above: The proposed site layout showing the new development and the surrounding context including the approved dwelling north and the existing frontage to Cheltenham Road.

Character of Building & Form

The character of the proposal seeks to create a simple contemporary form with a flat roof and finite pallet of materials to ensure that its presence in the street scene is muted and the building is visually low-impact.

The contemporary use of glazing, flat roof and low height would be ensure the new dwelling discretely settles into the natural context and responds specifically to the site's characteristics and constraints; being proximity to boundaries, prevailing building height, overbearingness and opportunity for high quality design.

The form of the building, being low and rectilinear intentionally does not seek to mimic the relatively mixed architectural style in the area; dominated by pitched roofs and brickwork, yet seeks to contrast and sit alone as an example of high-quality design and making the best use of the land.

Materials, Site Context and Detailing

The site, being set back and tucked away from the main highway and from existing built context provides an opportunity to utilise contemporary materials; in this case cementous cladding with shadow gap detailing to remain simple and crisp and allow the building to be viewed as a single, simple form. The building utilises a flat grass roof to boost biodiversity gains, capture rainwater and soften the dwelling within its setting.

The building has relatively minimal fenestration to its west 'principal' elevation and opens up to the north where the building surveys the proposed garden area.

The building, with a southern aspect, utilises solar PV and high levels of insulation to reduce any reliance on fossil fuel for heating, and would utilise SUDs techniques for storm drainage such as storage within the grass roof and on site rain harvesting.

Internal Layout

The proposed internal layout encompasses three bedrooms (2 double, 1 single) sharing a family bathroom and ensuite facilities. The main kitchen, dining and living space is orientated north with a large bi-folding opening to provide direct access to the garden areas. All bedroom and 'back of house' spaces are pushed to the boundaries of the site to focus the day-to-day living spaces to the parking and garden areas.

All bedrooms have large windows for natural light and to provide natural ventilation. The kitchen also has an associated utility room with external access. At the 'front' (east) of the new dwelling there is an entrance porch canopy and parking/turning space with direct access to the proposed car port.

Access

It is proposed that the existing access off 124 Cheltenham Road is retained for both the retained host dwelling (no. 124) and the new dwelling without needing to make any alterations to the existing building on site. Appropriate forward visibility is achieved at this access (as confirmed by the HA 'no objection' for application 22/00656/FUL).

There are no proposed changes to the level of parking and turning space for No.124 as part of the proposals and suitable levels of parking for the host dwelling will remain. The new dwelling proposes an open car port for its two parking spaces, as well as a turning area to the front of the new dwelling.

Following the severance of the application site to the existing dwelling, a new boundary feature will be installed along the south and west boundaries to enclose the garden of no.124 from the application site.

It is considered that there would be no harm to highway safety arising from the access and parking arrangements.

Biodiversity

A preliminary ecological assessment (PEA) was undertaken by Arbor Vitae Ltd and accompanies this application. The report confirms that there will be a loss of shrubs, grassland and trees as part of the proposals. At section 4.2 the report confirms the impacts and any mitigation to ecological changes on site.

In essence there is little habitat on site that currently have any ecological significance, where much of the garden consists of laid to lawns and ornamental shrub and tree planting. Where there are proposed removals of shrubs and grasses, the proposals would include for new soft landscape planting within the garden area of the site to provide net gains, and where non-native trees and hedgerows are proposed to be removed new native hedgerows and trees are proposed to be planted to provide net gains in biodiversity.

Further ecological enhancement will be achieved by:

1. Installing 2x Woodcrete nesting bird boxes on the building
2. Installing 1x Built-in swift brick
3. Installing 1x Build-in Bee brick

During the course of construction works there will be a 'Reasonable avoidance method statement' to ensure that no important or protected species (such as Hedgehogs) are impacted by construction works.

6. Conclusion

The proposal is considered to be sensitive to the local and wider environment, and the proposed dwelling seeks to promote a high architectural design through the use of contemporary form, sensitive mass and siting, and use of renewable technologies.

The proposal would not give rise to any planning harm, namely any harm to neighbouring properties and amenity but also to local distinctiveness and character. The proposal would be in keeping with its immediate surroundings and represent high quality design.

The proposal would represent the best use of land within the settlement of Bishops Cleeve which is a large village capable of supporting new development. On that basis the proposals would represent sustainable development and should be approved without delay.